



Touch to transact

Axis Bank account holders can now make transactions using Apple's Touch ID using the Axis Bank iOS app on the iPhone 5s and above



iMobile updated

ICICI Bank's mobile banking app iMobile now has over 100 services, claiming to offer more services from any other Indian bank.

Lenovo IdeaPad YOGA 500

A hit and miss hybrid story



feeling too big to operate on comfortably – which is exactly what happens with the Lenovo YOGA 500. Having said that, it weighs just about 2 kg, which is pretty good as far as portability goes.

The unit's touch response is great, its viewing angles are good, too. At 185.1 cd/m², the YOGA 500's screen brightness is mediocre at best, but its contrast ratio at 420:1 is definitely very good – the best we've seen in notebooks at this price point. However, in terms of performance, it's not very good – its CPU score is good, but its battery life of 201 minutes is lesser than many budget notebooks that are a lot more inexpensive than the YOGA 500. Both in tablet and notebook mode, the YOGA 500 performs well in terms of multimedia – whether it's watching a movie or listening to music, where its onboard speakers don't disappoint. Temperature-wise, it doesn't get uncomfortably hot on the YOGA 500's bottom panel while you use it in anyone of its several usage modes.

As far as the YOGA 500's features go, it's all pretty much a standard fare here. You get what you'd expect any self-respecting laptop to have, apart from one thing: just a paltry 500GB hard drive doesn't really cut it for a hybrid notebook selling over 60k. The lack of a discrete GPU also affects the YOGA's graphics performance, another inexcusable sin at this price. But as ever, no complaints from the YOGA 500's keyboard or touchpad – two aspects of a notebook that are Lenovo's traditional strengths. The keyboard is great to type on, and the touchpad is fine to use, too.

As a notebook, the YOGA 500 offers great usability and build quality, but inadequate hardware which contributes to its low performance. As a

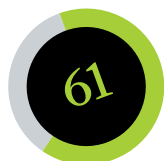
tablet, it offers a large touch-screen panel to use and play with, but one that's difficult to use practically with one hand for too long. Overall, the combination isn't readily palatable given its 60k price tag, and therefore difficult to recommend. Buy the YOGA 500 with better specs (which Lenovo offers) or buy the smaller YOGA 300 if you want a nice hybrid notebook. But not this.

Jayesh Shinde

The hybrid era is well and truly underway. In the latest chapter of the convergence story of laptops and tablets, we find brands experimenting with form factors. The Lenovo YOGA 500 is one such experiment.

Lenovo's YOGA line of hybrid notebooks needs no introduction to be honest. Right from the inaugural YOGA 13 launched in 2012 to every iteration since, every single YOGA laptop has gone through our grinder. And when Lenovo sent us this 14-inch YOGA 500, we raised more than one eyebrow.

Straight-out-of-the-box, the Lenovo YOGA hybrid notebook looks pleasing to the eye and feels tightly packed together. The notebook feels more playful than premium, aimed at consumers of all kinds. The two parts of this hybrid laptop are held together by a solid metal hinge, which lets the screen lid and bottom panel rotate up to 360 degrees without feeling anxious or fearful – the build quality exudes a lot of confidence. However, its design – especially the frame – poses some challenges while handling the notebook in tablet mode. Where 10-11 inch tablets are convenient, 12-13 inch onwards you start feeling the intimidating size, and past 13-inches the hybrid in tablet mode just starts



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Specifications

Screen: 14-inch glossy LED, 1366x768 res;
CPU: 2.2 GHz Intel Core i5-5200U; **RAM:** 4GB;
HDD: 500GB; **OS:** 64-bit Windows 8.1; **Connectivity:** USB 2.0 x 1, USB 3.0 x 2, HDMI, Gigabit Ethernet, SD Card slot; **Webcam:** Yes; **Touchscreen:** Yes; **Wireless:** Wi-Fi 802.11ac, Bluetooth 4.0; **Weight:** 2 kg

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